



TWO'S COMPANY:
Dutt (left) and Singh

Politically Incorrect

MUMBAI From villain to doctor, Sanjay Dutt may have enacted an array of roles on screen. But his recent hopes of becoming a member of Parliament in real life have met with stiff opposition from suburban Mumbai residents who aren't too impressed with his off-screen Gandhigiri. Days after the actor's announcement on his proposed political debut, members of various resident associations in

Bandra, Khar and Santacruz (the constituency his sister Priya Dutt represents) met to raise their voice against his possible candidature. "We don't want someone with a criminal record to represent us in Parliament. Besides, what has he done for our area," asks Anandini Thakoor, managing trustee of Khar Residents' Association.

Speaking at the birth-day celebrations of Vile Parle MLA Ashok Jadhav,

the actor, who faces charges in the 1993 Mumbai bomb blasts case, had expressed his desire to contest elections. His statement led to whispers within the city Congress that 'Munnabhai' would be a better crowd-puller than his sister, who apparently isn't very popular among local party workers. Even as party workers hinted at the actor being given a ticket from his father, Sunil Dutt's constituency, sp's Abu Asim Azmi declared, "sp would welcome Sanjay if he wishes to contest elections and join the party."

Irked by this open offer to a person with a "criminal record", six residents' associations intend launching a signature campaign and writing to all political parties urging them to steer clear of the actor. "He still has charges against him and if he has to go to jail again, are we to have elections again? It is citizens' money that is being wasted on such matters," protests Thakoor. For Dutt, his political aspirations may just have to wait a little longer.

by Aditi Pai

SIGNPOSTS

DIED: Tarabai Vartak, 82. She was India's first lady Zila Parishad president from Thane, Mumbai in 1972.



SENTENCED: Vikas Yadav (left) and Vishal Yadav, to life imprisonment by a Delhi court

for the murder of Nitish Katara. Vikas is the son of former Rajya Sabha member D.P. Yadav.

SENTENCED: By a local court, ex-minister of state for animal husbandry Aditya Singh and his son Suman Singh to life imprisonment for the murder of a brick kiln owner in Govastha, Bihar.

WON: By the men's archery team, the gold medal at the Meteksan World Cup archery meet in Antalya, Turkey.

WON: By Sudarshan Pattanaik, the People's Choice prize at the First Moscow International Sand Sculpture Championship, for his 15-ft Ganesha.

VIS-A-VIS VASUNDHARA RAJE Rajasthan chief minister versus PRAKASH KARAT CPI(M) general secretary

If the Gurjars break the law and cause problems in the state, we won't spare them. Nobody will be harsher than us.



Vasundhara Raje believes she has a divine right to rule, like a feudal ruler. We want her resignation.

EPILOGUE: In the war of caste and creed, only a divine element had been missing so far.